

1. THE “HOW MIGHT WE” STATEMENT

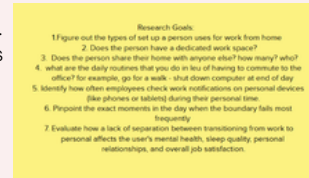
I began this project with a problem statements of: Full time work from home professionals struggle to disconnect from work at the end of the day due to the physical blurring of personal and professional spaces. This result overworking, high rates of chronic burnout, and a measurable drop in long term mental well being. I ultimately decided on a how might we statement of “How might we assist work from home employees in establishing clear boundaries between their professional and personal lives within the same space?”



2. RESEARCH

I created research goals to better understand what types of questions I wanted to ask the participants. Based on the research goals I formed a survey and received 6 participant responses. Once the survey was closed, I affinity mapped the participant responses and discovered some key insights:

- *5 of 6 participants have no transition activity going from work time to personal time
- *3 of 6 participants will do “just one more thing” when they are done usual work hours



Personas were created to better understand the participants situations, needs, pain points, and frustrations.

3. CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT

Based on the research insights that I gathered in the research phase, I brainstormed some ideas and concepts that I wanted my app to include:

- *something that reminded users that their work day was ending
- *something to help the user transition from “work time” to “personal time”
- *A lock out from work apps so that it makes it harder for the user to complete “just one more thing”

With this in mind, I started on low-fidelity wireframes:

- Screen 1-Gently nudges the user to stop working without causing anxiety.
- Screen 2-Clear the user’s working memory so they don’t carry the stress into their evening.
- Screen 3-Provides a highly tactile, satisfying physical action to close out the workday
- Screen 4-Gives options for a physical or mental transition from “work” to “personal” time.
- Screen 5-Reinforces the boundary of work and personal time and rewards the user for completing the habit.

My low-fidelity screens were then made into high-fidelity screens to better develop the app idea and concept.

USER PERSONA

NAME
Participant #4

AGE
34

OCCUPATION
Web Developer

BACKGROUND
This participant is currently working from home. They have a combination of dedicated home office and a non-dedicated room. They live with a partner. When they are done work for the day, they turn off the monitor and leave the room. This participant feels that a mentor or a guide to help navigate personal time to be “off” work would be meaningful. Would like to have gentle reminders to take care of self.

CHALLENGES

Main pain points:

- no time for self-care
- Needs clearer boundary about what is best for self.
- Work tools are visible, which reminds them of tasks left undone.

Frustrations:

- Opens laptop to do “just one more thing” during personal hours (3 of 5)
- Checks or replies to work notifications during off hours (3 of 5)

When asked the question: If you could wave a magic wand, what is the single thing that would help you mentally or physically leave work behind at the end of the day?
Participant responded: “Feeling confident that I got my work done and nothing needs to be worked on.”



4. END RESULT/CONCLUSION:

This project set out to solve a modern crisis of remote work and the blurred lines of “work time” and “personal time” for work from home professionals. By analyzing data collected, and creating personas I discovered that people lack a physical, purposeful transition from work to personal time, this creates anxiety and uncertainty and “blur” between work and personal time. Based on my research I also found that participants want something that indicates or gently reminds them that it is time to stop working. With all of this in mind, the “virtual commute” was designed.